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Early cancer tests raise awareness, fears

Usage up, as are questions on expense, effectiveness

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

If you could know your risk for developing cancer, would you want to?

Increasingly, people are saying yes. Personalized cancer screening and detection tests have surged in recent years, and accessing them is easier than ever.

As the impending divorce between longtime partners Dana-Farber Cancer Institute and Brigham and Women's Hospital, now a part of the Mass General Brigham system, barrels toward finality, local hospitals are pouring time and re-



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Dr. Lecia Sequist is the director of the MGB Cancer Institute Early Detection program.

sources into cancer care — and getting in on the early detection action.

In the last few years, MGB and Dana-Farber have each formed centers dedicated to finding and researching cancers at their earliest stages — when they're easiest to treat. Doctors at the centers are coordinating not only which screenings patients would benefit from, but what, if anything, they should do with the results.

"There are multiple companies who are trying to develop blood-based screening tests where you could maybe screen for multiple cancers with a single test," said Dr. Lecia Sequist, an oncologist and director of the MGB Cancer Institute Early Detection and Diagnostics Program.

But she said not all of those tests have been

CANCER, Page A7

Mass Save succeeds, but costs still high

As ratepayers feel pain, some seek to shift its focus away from emissions goals

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

Last year, between heat pump installations, home insulation, new energy-efficient appliances, and more, the Mass Save program helped transform tens of thousands of buildings into lean, mean, climate change-fighting machines, while eliminating emissions equivalent to 900,000 gasoline-powered cars.

It was, by many measures, a resounding success.

But there's another perspective, too, that Mass

► **Boston set to host its first "Climate Week."** B1.

Save is a money suck, its fees adding to Massachusetts ratepayers' already crushing utility bills. As complaints from consumers mount, some lawmakers on Beacon Hill, both Democrats and Republicans, want to slash \$1 billion from Mass Save's current \$4.5 billion, three-year budget — a step that would effectively gut the program, at least in the short term.

So which one is it? Financial drain or money saver — and climate hero — for Massachusetts utility customers?

The concerns about extra charges are real —

MASS SAVE, Page A6

For fans, a season of discontent

From the Garden to Fenway, loyalties are bruised but unbroken



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

A couple of Celtics fans couldn't bear to watch during the fourth quarter in the team's loss to the 76ers Saturday night.

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF
and Truman Dickerson
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

It's feeling like a tough spring for deflated Boston sports fans.

As the Celtics faltered in the fourth quarter of their Game 7 in the NBA playoffs Saturday night, T-shirt vendors were already packing up for the season outside TD Garden. In a few minutes, the stacks of green and black Boston-themed merchandise had abruptly disappeared.

"We thought we were going to have a long run," said Chris Rioux, a dejected Celtics die-hard from Biddeford, Maine.

The mood was like a funeral procession, as shell-shocked fans marched onto chilly Causeway Street, faces downtrodden, clutching their white Game 7 shirts in their hands. Some blamed the coaching, the refereeing, the absence of Jayson Tatum. Some didn't say anything at all.

One vendor started playing Frank Sinatra crooning "That's Life" on a large portable speaker.

But for sports fans in this erstwhile City of Champions, it wasn't the kind of life they'd envisioned for this spring. Just

SPORTS, Page A10



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Bruins head coach Marco Sturm spoke Sunday during the team's end-of-season press conference at Warrior Ice Arena. It was a day of reflection for both the Bruins and Celtics. C1.

AI in, teachers out: New school targets Boston

Much-debated company wants to open classes in fall

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Forget teachers. Say goodbye to one-sized-fits-all lessons. No more blackening ovals with No. 2 pencils.

Instead, hand each student a laptop loaded with an AI tutor. Let kids work at their own level and pace. Replace teachers with "guides" who monitor students' progress, rather than delivering lectures.

Welcome to Alpha School, which is pushing to open this fall in Boston. Championed by the Trump administration, the controversial but growing network of schools has 500 students across a dozen locations from California to New York.

The private, for-profit schools claim children can "crush academics" in just two hours a day with AI, freeing up more time for physical education, arts workshops, science projects, and more.

Alpha has pitched a kindergarten through eighth grade school for 25 students on Cambridge Street in Beacon Hill, with the goal of doubling to 50 for the following year. The company is also planning a second location somewhere in the suburbs, according to the company.

SCHOOLS, Page A7

May ray! May ray!

Monday: Warmer, sunny.
High 69-74, low 51-56.

Tuesday: Early sun, breezy.
High 73-78, low 56-61.

Sunrise: 5:35. Sunset: 7:47.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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Boston agreed to pay \$850,000 to protesters to settle a lawsuit that alleged police officers beat and pepper-sprayed them during rallies following the murder of George Floyd. B1.

President Trump said US forces will guide stranded ships from the contentious Strait of Hormuz. A3.

Two throwback publications, Yankee magazine and Old Farmer's Almanac, are beating the odds in this digital publishing era. A Q&A with their chief executive. D1.

The Artemis space mission has breathed new life into the Christa C. McAuliffe Center in Framingham. B1.

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A sweeping problem in Cambridge

Stiffer fines can't get drivers to move cars

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — Residents here cheered when the city in 2023 ended its longstanding practice of towing cars parked illegally on street sweeping days.

All that officials asked of drivers was for them to hold up their end of the bargain, by getting out of the way.

Far too many haven't, officials said this week.

Even after Cambridge more than tripled the fine to \$100 for parking illegally on street sweeping days, city data show just as many people are either not sufficiently motivated by the cost, or are willing to simply eat it.

"Residents are not moving their cars at

STREET SWEEPERS, Page A10



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2023

Officer Matt Brown ticketed a car during street sweeping hours in Cambridge.